

INNOVATION AND INVESTMENT DEVELOPMENT OF THE REGIONAL TOURIST INFRASTRUCTURE OF UKRAINE

Tetiana Herasymenko

*Candidate of Geological Sciences,
Associate Professor, Dnipro University
of Technology, Dnipro, Ukraine*

The innovative development of tourist infrastructure is a key factor in the economic growth of regions under modern conditions of economic transformation. The article analyzes the role of the latest technologies, environmentally sustainable solutions, and modern management approaches in increasing the competitiveness of regions in the global tourism market. It examines the significance of regional tourism in attracting investments, creating new jobs, and improving the quality of life of local communities. The study examines the impact of implementing innovative solutions in transport and hotel infrastructure, as well as the development of digital technologies, on enhancing the attractiveness and comfort of tourist services for visitors. In the context of comparing the tourism activity of the Dnipropetrovsk region with that of other regions in Ukraine, the article highlights the importance of an investment and innovation approach as a driver for the sustainable growth of the tourism sector.

Keywords: innovative development, regional tourism infrastructure, sustainable development, investment regional economy, economic transformation, regional attractiveness

* * * *

The innovative development of regional tourism infrastructure is significant in today's globalization and economic transformation conditions. Regional tourism is becoming a key factor in stimulating economic growth, attracting investment and creating new jobs. Infrastructure projects aimed at improving tourism services and logistics contribute to increasing the attractiveness of regions for tourists, which is especially important for countries seeking to diversify their economies. The implementation of innovative solutions in transport, hotel business, information technology and environmental practices is becoming a necessary condition for the competitiveness of regions in the world tourism market.

Given the growing demand for ecological, cultural and gastronomic tourism, innovations in infrastructure can make regions more accessible, comfortable and attractive for different categories of tourists. This is of particular importance for Ukraine, which seeks to integrate into the European tourist space, using its nat-

ural, cultural and historical potential. The development of modern tourist infrastructure based on innovations will not only increase the level of tourist services, but also contribute to the sustainable development of regions and improve the quality of life of local communities.

Each of these elements plays an important role in creating a positive tourist experience and contributes to the overall development of the region as a tourist destination. Innovations in each of these areas can increase the attractiveness of the region for tourists and contribute to the sustainable development of tourism infrastructure.

Innovative development of regional tourism infrastructure covers a wide range of issues related to the introduction of the latest technologies, environmentally sustainable solutions and modern management approaches. In today's world, innovations are the main driver of change, and the tourism industry is one of the sectors actively transforming under their influence. Innovative development includes renewal of transport networks, modernization of the hotel industry, implementation of digital solutions for interaction with tourists, development of smart tourism systems, and others [6].

Special emphasis is placed on regional tourism, since regions are the source of unique natural, cultural and historical resources capable of attracting domestic and international tourists. The successful development of tourism infrastructure in the regions contributes to the creation of new economic opportunities, the improvement of the quality of life of the population and the preservation of cultural heritage. Therefore, the issue of innovative development of tourist infrastructure is important for ensuring the sustainable development of regions and the overall competitiveness of the tourism industry.

In modern economic changes, tourism infrastructure is an important factor in the development of tourism and the stimulation of economic growth. The impact of high-quality infrastructure on the tourism business is directly related to increasing competitiveness and attracting investment. The works of Boshota N.V. and Papp V.V. emphasize the importance of effective tourism infrastructure for the development of tourism,

its role in ensuring a comfortable stay for tourists and improving service, which contributes to the growth of economic indicators of enterprises in this area. The authors note that the optimization of infrastructure improves the quality of tourism services and creates conditions for the sustainable development of the sector [4]. An analysis of the works of Boshota N.V. shows that the modernization and expansion of infrastructure are key to improving the quality of tourism and economic benefits for tourism business enterprises [5]. Lendel O.D. focuses on the state of infrastructure to ensure the proper level of tourism services [7]. The author proposes new methods for assessing the effectiveness of infrastructure and ways to improve it for the sustainable development of the tourism industry. Makarchuk I.M. and others emphasize the importance of combining tourism resources and infrastructure for sustainable growth and economic stability of regions [8]. Pokolodna M.M. and Pisareva I.V. emphasize the importance of developing tourism infrastructure taking into account regional characteristics and propose strategies for attracting tourists and improving the experience [10]. Studies by Slashchuk A. and Bernads'ka G. focus on the classification of tourism infrastructure and the relationships between its elements for the effective functioning of the system [11]. Chetyrbuk O.R., Golod A.P. and Fabio A. analyze the development of tourism infrastructure taking into account various natural features of territories. They investigated how the diversity of infrastructure facilities affects the attraction of tourists and increasing the economic efficiency of tourism [3]. Adeya P. and Lisle D. highlight the key factors of tourism infrastructure efficiency, in particular, development in accordance with international standards and the integration of modern technologies and innovations in management [1]. Apriyanti M. and Sumaryoto M. assess the importance of tourism infrastructure for attracting domestic and international tourists, proposing tools to improve its effectiveness [2]. Recent studies confirm the importance of tourism infrastructure development for the growth of the tourism economy. Modernization and innovative approaches in infrastructure management improve the quality of tourist services and stimulate the economic development of the industry.

The development of tourism, as well as ensuring a high level of competitiveness in the long term, is inextricably linked to the development, implementation and improvement of innovations. The tourism sector creates twice as many jobs as the financial sector and five times more than the chemical industry, which emphasizes the importance of the development of the tourism industry in Ukraine at all levels [9].

It should be clearly understood that the effective development of both the tourism sector and the region in

general, in modern conditions, is possible only through the path of innovative development, which includes the application of investment and innovation management mechanisms. In this context, a two-way process of innovation and investment is observed: investments can be attracted only for the implementation of innovative approaches and solutions, and at the same time, innovative solutions cannot be implemented without attracting investments.

Effective development of the tourism sector depends on the investment and innovation approach. Investments and innovations are interrelated processes, since innovative projects can be implemented only if there is sufficient funding, and investments are usually directed to the introduction of the latest technologies and solutions.

When conducting an investment and innovation analysis of the tourism industry in Dnipropetrovsk region, it is advisable to compare it with regions of Ukraine that have a developed infrastructure for various types of tourism, such as cultural and educational, event, health, gastronomic and rural, which will make it possible to identify strengths and weaknesses of each region and understand what strategies can be successfully applied to boost tourism in Dnipropetrovsk region.

Zaporizhzhia region can be compared with Dnipropetrovsk region in terms of the development of cultural and historical tourism (Cossack heritage) and active recreation. It is also important to compare the role of river resources (Dnieper) in the development of tourism.

Poltava region should be considered for comparison in the context of cultural and educational tourism, especially through historical routes and museums. Both regions can be compared in terms of the level of development of domestic tourism and the popularization of cultural objects.

Kharkiv Oblast is similar to Dnipropetrovsk Oblast in the level of urbanization and industrial development, so it should be compared in terms of the level of development of urban and event tourism, as well as the popularization of the cultural heritage of large cities.

Although Dnipropetrovsk Oblast does not have direct access to the sea, the comparison with Odesa Oblast can be useful in terms of the development of urban tourism, cultural events and gastronomic tours, as Dnipro is also a large city with potential for festivals and cultural initiatives.

Kirovohrad Oblast should be compared with Dnipropetrovsk Oblast in terms of rural and ecotourism development opportunities, as well as the study of new tourist products that can attract domestic tourists.

Vinnitsia Oblast has a similar balance between industrial and cultural development, so a comparison

with Dnipropetrovsk may be useful in terms of health and cultural tourism.

Chernihiv region can be interesting for comparison in the context of the development of historical routes, religious tourism and attraction of domestic tourists to architectural monuments.

On an all-Ukrainian scale, investments in the sphere of temporary accommodation and catering remained stable at the level of 0.4–0.5% during 2015–2021, which indicates a certain stability of attention to this sector, but without significant growth. Investments in the field of arts, sports, entertainment and recreation showed moderate growth, in particular in 2019 – up to 0.7%, but in 2020–2021 it returned to 0.5–0.6%, which may be related to economic challenges such as the COVID-19 pandemic (See the table 1).

Investments in temporary accommodation and catering in Dnipropetrovsk region fluctuated: the highest level was in 2019 (0.7%), but already in 2020 it fell to 0.2%, which indicates the instability of this sector. For arts, sports, entertainment and recreation, investment has gradually declined from 0.3% in 2015 to 0% in 2021, indicating a significant decline in interest in this area.

The Zaporizhzhia region shows interesting dynamics. In 2015, a high level of investment in temporary accommodation and catering was recorded (1.6%), but by 2021 this indicator has decreased to 0.1%. Investments in arts, sports, entertainment and recreation have also fluctuated, but growth in 2021 to 0.8% may indicate new investment initiatives in this area.

Investments in Poltava region in both areas remain low and stable, without significant changes during 2015–2021. Temporary accommodation is fixed at

0.1%, while investment in arts, sports, entertainment and leisure also remains at 0.1%, indicating limited interest in developing tourism infrastructure in the region.

In the Kharkiv region, there is a significant drop in investments in temporary accommodation and catering from 0.7% in 2015 to 0% in 2021. However, investment in arts, sports, entertainment and recreation shows steady growth, especially since 2017 (from 1.4% to 3.6% in 2021), indicating significant development in this area in the region, possibly due to sports and cultural projects

Odesa region shows consistently high investment rates in temporary accommodation and catering, peaking in 2015 (1.9%) and stabilizing at 0.9% in 2021. This confirms the strong tourist infrastructure of the region. Investment in arts, sports, entertainment and recreation remains low, indicating less interest in this area compared to other regions.

Kirovohrad and Vinnytsia regions have minimal indicators of investments in temporary accommodation (up to 0.1%) and art, sports, entertainment and recreation (up to 0.2%), which indicates insufficient development of tourist services and lack of significant investments in tourist infrastructure.

Investments in temporary accommodation in the Chernihiv region also remain low and stable here, at the level of 0.1–0.3%. Investment in arts, sports, entertainment and recreation was at 0.4% in 2015, but rose again to 0.3% in 2021 after a temporary decline, indicating some investment initiatives.

Dnipropetrovsk region shows unstable investments in the tourism sphere, in particular, a decline in the sphere of art, sports, entertainment and recreation,

Table 1

Capital investments by regions of Ukraine in the tourism sphere, in % of the total volume of investments by region [12]

Region	Temporary accommodation and catering						Art, sports, entertainment and recreation					
	2015	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2015	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
Ukraine	0,5	0,5	0,5	0,4	0,4	0,4	0,4	0,4	0,6	0,7	0,5	0,6
Dnipropetrovsk	0,2	0,3	0,5	0,7	0,2	0,3	0,3	0,2	0,2	0,2	0,1	0
Zaporizhzhia	1,6	0,5	0,9	0,5	0,7	0,1	0,1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0,8
Poltava	0,1	0,2	0,1	0,1	0,1	0	0,1	0,1	0,1	0,1	0,1	0
Kharkivska	0,7	0,4	0,2	0,2	0,1	0	0,3	1,4	1,2	2,1	2,2	3,6
Odesa	1,9	0,5	0,8	0,9	1,5	0,9	0,1	0,1	0,2	0,2	0,1	0,1
Kirovohradsk	0	0	0	0	0	0	0,2	0,2	0,3	0,1	0,1	0,1
Vinnytsia	0,1	0,1	0,1	0,1	0,1	0	0,2	0,2	0,1	0,1	0,1	0,1
Chernihivska	0,2	0,1	0,3	0,1	0,1	0,1	0,4	0,2	0,1	0,3	0,1	0,3

which indicates the need to stimulate investments to support the development of cultural and entertainment tourism.

Zaporizhzhia and Odesa regions remain attractive for investors in the field of temporary accommodation, but it is worth investing more in the development of the cultural and entertainment segment.

Kharkiv region is a clear leader in the field of art, sports and entertainment, where significant growth in investments is observed, which indicates successful investment strategies in this direction.

Poltava, Kirovohrad and Vinnytsia regions have low investment indicators, which indicates the need for additional efforts to stimulate the development of tourism infrastructure.

The tourism industry has significant potential for economic development as it creates jobs and attracts foreign capital. In today's world, where globalization and technological changes rapidly affect all sectors of the economy, the development of tourism infrastructure with an emphasis on innovation allows regions to remain competitive.

Special emphasis should be placed on the development of regional tourism, since the regions themselves are carriers of unique natural, cultural and historical resources capable of attracting both domestic and international tourists. The successful implementation of innovations in the tourist infrastructure of the regions will increase the quality of tourist services, contribute to the sustainable development of local communities, preserve cultural heritage and raise the standard of living of the population.

Innovative and investment development of regional tourism infrastructure is an important factor in the long-term strategy of regional development. It requires a comprehensive approach that includes modernization of infrastructure, introduction of new technologies, investment attraction and development of environmentally sustainable practices to ensure sustainable growth of tourism potential.

REFERENCES:

1. Adeya, P., Lisle, D. (2024). Tourism Infrastructures. *Tourism GeoGraphies*, P. 1-11. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1080/14616688.2024.2412543>.
2. Apriyanti, M., Sumaryoto, M. (2024). The Importance of Tourism Infrastructure in Increasing Domestic and International Tourism. *International Journal of Research In Vocational Studies (IJRVOCAS)*, Vol. 3 (4), P. 113-122. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.53893/ijrvocas.v3i4.46>.
3. Chetyrbuk, O.R., Holod, A.P., Fabio, A. (2024). Rozvytok turystychnoyi infrastruktury na riznykh typakh terytoriy [Development of tourist infrastructure in different types of territories]. *Ekonomika ta suspil'stvo*, Vol. 62. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.32782/2524-0072/2024-62-162>.
4. Boshota, N.V., Papp, V.V. (2017). Turystychna infrastruktura ta yiyi rol' u rozvytku turyzmu v rehioni [Tourist infrastructure and its role in the development of tourism in the region]. *Naukovyy visnyk Uzhhorods'koho universytetu*, Vol. 2(50), P. 117-122. Retrieved from: <http://visnyk-ekon.uzhnu.edu.ua/article/view/136726>.
5. Boshota, N. V. (2018). Rol' turystychnoyi infrastruktury u diyal'nosti pidpryemstv turystychnoho biznesu [The role of tourism infrastructure in the activities of tourism business enterprises]. *Scientific Notes of Lviv University of Business and Law*, Vol. 18, P. 21-26. Retrieved from: <https://nzlubp.org.ua/index.php/journal/article/view/5>.
6. Davydova, O. (2015). Peculiarities of using innovations in the development of the tourism industry of Ukraine. *Visnyk Kyivs'koho natsional'noho universytetu imeni Tarasa Shevchenka. Ekonomika*. № 7 (172). P. 65-69.
7. Lendyel, O.D. (2020). Otsinka stanu infrastruktury rehional'noho rynku turystychnykh posluh [Assessment of the infrastructure of the regional market of tourist services]. *Naukovyy visnyk Mukachivs'koho derzhavnoho universytetu*, Vol. 13, P. 159-168. DOI: [https://doi.org/10.31339/2313-8114-2020-1\(13\)-159-168](https://doi.org/10.31339/2313-8114-2020-1(13)-159-168).
8. Makarchuk, I. M., Perchuk, O. V., Perchuk, O. V. (2020). Turystychni resursy ta infrastruktura yak vazhlyvi skladovi rozvytku ekonomiky ta turyzmu rehionu [Tourist resources and infrastructure as important components of the development of the economy and tourism of the region]. *Ekonomichnyy visnyk universytetu*, Vol. 45 (15), № 2. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.31470/2306-546X-2020-45-93-99>.
9. Ogienko, M. (2020). Development of regional tourist markets through the introduction of innovations. *Ekonomichnyy prostir*. № 164. P. 152-159.
10. Pokolodna, M. M., Pysareva, I. V. (2019). Rozvytok turyst-s'koyi infrastruktury: rehional'nyy aspekt [Development of tourist infrastructure: regional aspect]. *Rozvytok produktyvnykh syl i rehional'na ekonomika*, Vol. 33, P. 209-217. Retrieved from: http://www.market-infr.od.ua/journals/2019/28_2019_ukr/33.pdf.
11. Slashchuk, A., Bernads'ka, H. (2019). Naukovi pidkhody do vyznachennya ta klasyfikatsiyi turystychnoyi infrastruktury [Scientific approaches to the definition and classification of tourist infrastructure]. *Skhidnoyevropeys'kyy natsional'nyy universytet imeni Lesi Ukrayinky*, Vol. 81, P. 12-17. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.17721/2413-7154/2019.81.12-17>.
12. Tourist barometer of Ukraine 2021-2022. Kiev. Retrieved from: <https://nto.ua/assets/files/ntou-statistics-barometer-2021-2022.pdf>